

**It's crunch time!**

CD Projekt Red is implementing a crunch period ahead of Cyberpunk 2077's November release. <http://digit.in/oct20-81>

**Final Fantasy XVI will be M-rated**

Final Fantasy is officially the very first Mature-rated game in the series. <http://digit.in/oct20-82>

# The Page 3 of the Internet

## Boo-Man laments over his favourite platform going to \$#17

**Boo-Man** | [boo@digit.in](mailto:boo@digit.in)

**W**hy is it that every platform that I finally warm up to has to get flooded with the lowest common denominator and become a shadow of its former self? First it was the papers that I used to enjoy as a youngling, then came the instant messengers and after that we had the social media platforms such as MySpace, Hi5, Orkut and Facebook. Soon after that came the smart-phone focused platforms such as Twitter, Instagram and \*retch\* TikTok. Let's lose TikTok from the list, that one was garbage right from day one when all you could find with lewd videos that would make one gouge their eyes out.

Through my time on all these platforms, and some others which I shall not mention here, Reddit held out for the longest. Probably because their UI was so archaic that it took some getting used to. Newbies to Reddit wouldn't find it easy to understand the flow of comments or the multitudes of inside jokes or the goddamn UI. Not a lot would even stick around to see their first Cake Day. But if they did stick around, they'd discover what truly made the platform unique. The ethos, the culture, the people ... \*sigh\* it's all gone to \$#17 now.

I'd say things started going south when Reddit became mainstream. It had been the frontpage of the internet for a really long time and then it became the Page 3 of the internet. Asinine monetisation policies, a

revamped upvote/downvote algorithm and the advent of politically charged doofuses started invading and destroying what had once been one of the best message boards on the planet. The voting mechanism started having less of an effect as we started seeing surreptitiously disguised advertisements populate the feeds. The raw content made way for ad agency driven marketing campaigns creeping up in all sorts of subreddits.

Sure, some of the redditors banded together on r/HailCorporate and started bringing this to fore since non-disclosed advertisements are



still against the law of the land but it would seem like the new owners of Reddit have little care for the community that was and are more interested in minting money. Little or no action is taken against posts that even a two year-old could identify as an advertisement. You see a new trailer on YouTube for an upcoming movie and within 24 hours there are 3-4 front-page posts about it. How much more obvious can it get? Advertisers aren't going to start their campaign after all the buzz is over.

And what of the shining white knights who were supposed to

protect the platform? Yes, I'm talking about the Reddit mods. Well, they're all in cahoots with the advertisers. With easy messaging on the platform, it isn't long before a couple of thousand bucks makes it to the personal accounts of the mods for them to look the other way. Heck, not long ago it was alleged that 92 of the top 500 subs were controlled by the same four mods. Imagine the amount of power these individuals wield and obviously, the sheer amount of money they'd be making off the platform.

In the last presidential election, we saw every platform from Facebook and Twitter to Reddit becoming battlegrounds for politicised content. Subreddits were essentially waging wars against each other by means of vote-brigading. And folks who couldn't give two \$#17s were drawn into this polarised warfare for no reason. Freedom of speech soon took a hit as more and more silly rules were implemented by the lord's superiors i.e. the Reddit Admins. Some of the utterly racist and bigoted folk instantly branched out to greener pastures as soon as it was made clear that their kinda talk was no longer welcome. However, the rules that made them leave had a lasting impact on the rest of the redditors as even the slightly edgy and humorous subreddits took a hit.

Let's just say that it was good while it lasted. The platform held out long enough but eventually had to succumb to become another Facebook, Twitter, Instagram ... you name it. It's now a big advertisement portal with the useful stuff buried way under. For all I care, the admins of Reddit should just own up to all the shilling and rename subreddits as echo-chambers. What was once the front-page of the Internet has become just another silly portal for the witless. 